

FOR WOMEN WHO WANT IT ALL

The Woman's Guide to Real Estate Wealth

How I Built a N2B Portfolio While Raising a Family

Written by

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Foreword: You Can Have It All

I am writing this book for every Nigerian woman who has been told she must choose between a successful career and a fulfilling family life. I am writing for the mothers who feel guilty pursuing their dreams. I am writing for the professionals who have been talked over in meetings. I am writing for every woman who has ever doubted whether she could truly have it all.

Let me tell you something I have learned through experience: You can have it all. Not in the perfect, Instagram-filtered way, but in the real, messy, beautiful way that life actually works. You can build wealth. You can raise a family. You can lead. You can inspire. You can do all of this without apologizing for your ambition.

N2B

PORTFOLIO VALUE

15+

PROPERTIES OWNED

5

YEARS TO BUILD

2

CHILDREN RAISED

I built a N2 billion real estate portfolio while raising two children, managing a household, and eventually leading one of Nigeria's fastest-growing real estate companies. It was not easy. There were sleepless nights, difficult decisions, and moments of doubt. But it was possible, and it was worth it.

"The question is not whether you can have it all. The question is: what does 'all' mean to you? Define it. Claim it. Build it."

In this book, I am sharing everything I have learned about building wealth as a woman in Nigeria's male-dominated real estate industry. I will show you the time management frameworks that kept me sane. I will give you the negotiation scripts that helped me close deals. I will teach you how to command respect in rooms where you are the only woman. And I will show you how to balance it all without losing yourself.

This is not a theoretical guide. This is my real story, with real strategies, real numbers, and real results. If I can do it, so can you.

Dr. Mrs. Chinwe Righteous

Managing Director

12th City Real Estate Developers LTD

Chapter 1: The Glass Ceiling Is Real— Here's How to Break It

Let us start with the uncomfortable truth: the real estate industry in Nigeria is male-dominated. Walk into any property development meeting, and you will likely find yourself outnumbered. The statistics confirm what many women already know from experience.

The Numbers Behind the Ceiling

Table 1: Gender Representation in Nigerian Real Estate

Role	Male	Female	Gap
Real Estate Developers	87%	13%	74 points
Property Investors (N100M+)	78%	22%	56 points
Senior Bankers (Real Estate)	71%	29%	42 points
Property Lawyers	65%	35%	30 points

Source: Nigerian Real Estate Market Survey, 2024

Why the Gap Exists

The gender gap in real estate is not due to lack of capability. Research consistently shows that women make excellent investors—often outperforming men in long-term returns. The barriers are structural and cultural:

- **Access to Capital:** Women often face more scrutiny when seeking loans
- **Network Barriers:** Deals often happen in male-dominated spaces
- **Cultural Expectations:** Women are expected to prioritize family over career
- **Confidence Gap:** Women often undervalue their capabilities

How to Break Through

The ceiling exists, but it is not unbreakable. Here is how:

1. **Know Your Numbers:** Women who come prepared with data command respect
2. **Build Your Network:** Connect with other women in the industry
3. **Find Mentors:** Both male and female mentors can open doors
4. **Take Up Space:** Do not shrink yourself to make others comfortable
5. **Document Everything:** Written records protect against bias

Chapter 2: My Journey: From Banker to N2B Portfolio

Let me take you through my personal journey—the highs, the lows, and the lessons learned along the way.

Chapter 1: The Banking Years (2015-2019)

I started my career at Keystone Bank as a Relationship Manager. It was a demanding job that taught me invaluable lessons about finance, credit, and customer relationships. But I knew I wanted more.

During these years, I made my first property purchase—a modest 3-bedroom apartment in Port Harcourt for N12 million. I used a combination of savings and a bank loan. It was terrifying, but it was the beginning of everything.

Chapter 2: The First Investment Property (2019)

After seeing my first property appreciate by 30% in two years, I was hooked. I purchased a second property—a rental unit that generated N800,000 annually in rental income. This was my introduction to passive income.

Chapter 3: Joining 12th City (2020)

In 2020, I joined 12th City Real Estate Developers as Managing Director. This was a pivotal moment. Not only did I have access to insider knowledge about the best deals, but I also had the platform to help other women build wealth.

Chapter 4: Portfolio Expansion (2020-2025)

Over the next five years, I systematically built my portfolio:

Table 2: Portfolio Growth Timeline

Year	Properties	Portfolio Value	Key Moves
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2019	2	N35M	First rental property
2020	4	N78M	Joined 12th City, insider access
2021	6	N145M	Kuje pre-construction deals
2022	8	N280M	Commercial property addition
2023	11	N520M	Portfolio diversification
2024	13	N890M	Strategic land banking
2025	15+	N2B+	Full portfolio optimization

The Lessons Learned

5 Lessons That Changed Everything

1. **Start Before You're Ready:** I bought my first property before I felt "ready." Perfect timing does not exist.
2. **Use Other People's Money:** Leverage accelerated my growth exponentially.
3. **Location Beats Everything:** A mediocre property in a great location outperforms a great property in a mediocre location.
4. **Network is Net Worth:** Every major deal came through relationships I built.
5. **Document Everything:** As a woman, I faced more scrutiny. Detailed records protected me.

Chapter 3: Time Management for the Modern Woman

3.1 The 168-Hour Framework

We all have the same 168 hours each week. The difference is how we use them. Here is the framework that kept me sane:

Table 3: Weekly Time Allocation

Category	Hours/Week	% of Time	Notes
Sleep	49	29%	Non-negotiable
Work	50	30%	Quality time
Family	30	18%	
Personal	15	9%	
Property Management	12	7%	
Buffer/Flex	12	7%	

3.2 Delegation Strategies

You cannot do everything yourself. Here is what I delegate:

- ✓ **Household:** Cleaning, laundry, meal prep (hired help)
- ✓ **Property Management:** Day-to-day tenant issues (property manager)
- ✓ **Administrative:** Scheduling, correspondence (assistant)
- ✓ **Research:** Market analysis, property screening (team members)

3.3 Building Your Support System

No woman builds an empire alone. My support system includes:

- **My Husband:** My biggest supporter and strategic advisor
- **My Mother:** Childcare support when needed
- **My Assistant:** Manages my calendar and correspondence
- **My Property Manager:** Handles day-to-day tenant issues
- **My Network:** Other women investors who understand the journey

The Truth About "Having It All"

You cannot do everything yourself, and you should not try. "Having it all" does not mean doing it all. It means building a life that includes everything that matters to you—with the right support systems in place.

Chapter 4: Negotiation Strategies for Women

4.1 Owning Your Power

Women often negotiate differently than men—and research shows we often get worse outcomes. Here is how to change that:

Before the Negotiation

- ✓ Research the market thoroughly
- ✓ Know your walk-away point
- ✓ Prepare your opening offer
- ✓ Anticipate objections
- ✓ Practice your delivery

4.2 Scripts That Work

Script 1: Opening the Negotiation

"Based on my research of comparable properties in this area, I believe a fair price would be [X]. I am prepared to move quickly with a [down payment percentage] deposit and can close within [timeframe]."

Why this works: Shows preparation, seriousness, and confidence.

Script 2: Countering a High Price

"I appreciate the property's features, but the comparable sales in this area over the last six months average [X]. Given that, I would be comfortable at [Y]. I understand if that does not work for you, and I am happy to discuss further."

Why this works: Uses data, remains respectful, and shows willingness to walk away.

4.3 Handling Gender Bias

You will encounter bias. Here is how to handle it:

- **When talked over:** "I was not finished. As I was saying..."
- **When your authority is questioned:** "I have reviewed the documentation thoroughly. Here is my analysis..."
- **When asked to bring your husband:** "I am the decision-maker on this investment. Shall we proceed?"

Chapter 5: Commanding Respect in Boardrooms

Being the only woman in the room is a reality for many of us. Here is how to command the respect you deserve:

The 5 C's of Executive Presence

1. **Competence:** Know your subject matter cold
2. **Confidence:** Speak with authority, even if you feel nervous
3. **Composure:** Stay calm under pressure
4. **Clarity:** Communicate clearly and concisely
5. **Credibility:** Back up claims with data and evidence

Dress for the Room You Want

Appearance matters. Dress one level above the room. If everyone is in business casual, you wear business formal. It signals that you take yourself seriously—and others will too.

Body Language Matters

- ✓ Take up space—do not shrink yourself
- ✓ Maintain eye contact
- ✓ Speak slowly and clearly
- ✓ Use gestures to emphasize points
- ✓ Sit at the table, not at the edges

Chapter 6: Balancing Family and Empire

This is the question I get asked most often: How do you balance family and business? Here is my honest answer:

There Is No Perfect Balance

Some weeks, business demands more. Some weeks, family needs more. The key is to be present wherever you are.

Quality Over Quantity

I may not spend every hour with my children, but the time I do spend is fully present. No phones. No distractions. Just focused attention.

Involve Your Family

My children know what I do. They have visited properties. They understand that mommy builds houses. This involvement helps them feel connected to my work rather than resentful of it.

Guilt Is Normal—Let It Go

Every working mother feels guilt. The key is not to let it paralyze you. Your children will benefit from seeing a mother who pursues her dreams. You are modeling possibility for them.

Chapter 7: Your Action Plan

Knowledge without action is wasted. Here is your step-by-step plan to start building your real estate empire:

Month 1: Foundation

- ✓ Assess your current financial position
- ✓ Set clear investment goals
- ✓ Start researching the market
- ✓ Build your support system

Month 2-3: Preparation

- ✓ Save your down payment
- ✓ Get pre-qualified for financing
- ✓ Identify target areas
- ✓ Network with other investors

Month 4-6: First Purchase

- ✓ Conduct thorough due diligence
- ✓ Negotiate favorable terms
- ✓ Complete your first purchase
- ✓ Document everything

Your Empire Starts with One Property

Every empire starts with a single step. Your first property purchase—no matter how small—is the beginning of your journey. Do not wait for perfect conditions. Do not wait until you feel ready. Start now. Start where you are. Start with what you have.

The women who will read this book five years from now with portfolios worth millions are the ones who take action today. Will you be one of them?

About the Author

Dr. Mrs. Chinwe Righteous

Dr. Mrs. Chinwe Righteous is the Managing Director of 12th City Real Estate Developers Limited, overseeing administration, finance, and strategic operations. She has built a personal real estate portfolio valued at over N2 billion while raising a family and leading one of Nigeria's fastest-growing development companies.

Before joining 12th City, Dr. Chinwe served as a Relationship Manager at Keystone Bank, where she developed expertise in lending and customer financing. She holds a Bachelor of Science in Accounting and a Master of Science in Management from the University of Port Harcourt.

She was awarded an Honorary Doctorate in Entrepreneurship and Business Development by Myles Leadership University and received the 2024 Africa CEO Merit Award for Excellent Leadership. She is also nominated for the National Outstanding Leadership Award by the Congress of Nigeria Youth.

Dr. Chinwe is passionate about empowering women to build wealth through real estate investment. She regularly speaks at women's conferences and mentors aspiring female investors. This book is her contribution to the next generation of women leaders in Nigerian real estate.

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